Reading Comprehension English II

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What is reading?



- Reading is the process of looking at written symbols (letters and words) and constructing meaning from them.
- Reading is not just saying the words on a page; it is understanding, interpreting, and making meaning from what we read.
- Reading is an interactive process in which readers use their prior knowledge, language skills, and the written text to understand and interpret meaning.

Are we familiar with the reading strategies?

- *Skimming*
- *Scanning*
- *Inferencing*



- **Skimming**: Reading a text quickly to get the main idea or general meaning without focusing on every detail.

  Example: *Reading a newspaper article to understand what it is mainly about.*

- **Scanning**: Reading a text quickly to find specific information, such as a name, date, number, or keyword.
- **Example**: *Looking through a train schedule to find the departure time.*

- **Inferencing** (Making Inferences): Using information from the text together with your own background knowledge to understand information that is not stated directly.

- **Example**: *If someone says*, "*Sarah grabbed her umbrella before leaving*," *you can infer that it is probably raining or likely to rain*.

Price Hike in Bangladesh

Bangladesh is a little country with growing problems. Price hike is one of the major problems. The problem has spread its evil clutch all over the country. Price of everything is increasing day by day. People of fixed and limited income are suffering a lot. All are getting concerned with this problem. When price goes out of buying capability, it is called price hike.

There are many causes behind it. The first and foremost cause is over population. The small country cannot manufacture enough food for its increasing population. Man-made crisis of commodities is another cause.

Dishonest businessmen do it for higher profits. Business syndicate, smuggling and corruption depend on International market. Besides, anarchy and unawareness are responsible for it.

The effects of price hike are many. Many people are living under poverty line. So, their condition is becoming miserable. Many of them remain hungry almost every day. The poor children are leaving school in despair. There is no light of hope for balanced food. They cannot afford to buy any medicine. For price hike, the poor are becoming poorer. The problem of price hike is hindering overall development of our country. It is so horrible.

Common people have to take some immediate steps to bring down price of valuable commodities. At first, we have to control our population. Food production must be increased as soon as possible. Dishonest businessmen must be punished. For keeping price under control, we need political stability. The government should import indispensable commodities for a stable market. Farmers should be given easy-loan to harvest food. The government should store food to cope with any natural disaster. The government should sell essential commodities at a low price.

1A. Choose and write the best option for the following questions.

I. What is the main idea of the passage?

a)Bangladesh has many natural disasters.
b) Price hike is a serious problem affecting the country
c) The government has solved all economic problems
d) Farmers are responsible for poverty.

II.Which group of people suffers the most because of price hike?

a)Rich businessmen
b)Government employees
c) People with fixed and limited incomes
d) Foreign visitors.

III . According to the passage, which is one major cause of price hike?

a)Better education
b)Overpopulation
c) Tourism
d) Industrialization**.**

Why do dishonest businessmen create a shortage of commodities?

a) To reduce production
b) To earn higher profits
c) To help consumers
d) To support farmers.

v. Which of the following is suggested as a solution to price hike?

a) Closing all markets
b) Increasing food production
c) Reducing education
d) Importing luxury goods

In the context of the passage, write the word that matches the suitable definitions below.

Words: Population, Poverty, Corruption, Commodities, Stability

i. _____ the total number of people living in a country
ii. _____ dishonest or illegal behavior for personal benefit
iii. _____ goods or products that are bought and solid
iv. _____ the state of being extremely poor
v. _____ a condition in which a country remains peaceful and well-governed

C. Write short answers to the following questions in your own words.

i. What is meant by "price hike"?
ii. Mention any two causes of price hike discussed in the passage.
iii. How does price hike affect poor families?
iv. Why is increasing food production important?
v. Mention any two measures that can help control price hike.
vi. Which solution mentioned in the passage do you think is the most effective? Explain your answer.

D. Write a summary of the passage in your own words.

Guidelines for Writing a Good Summary

1.Read the passage carefully and identify its main idea.

2.**Begin your summary with phrases** such as:

This passage **discusses**...
The passage **deals with**...
The passage **highlights**...
The passage **focuses on**...
The passage **sheds light on**...

Starting options

The passage discusses the issue of price hike in Bangladesh**.**

The passage highlights the growing problem of price hike in Bangladesh**.**

The passage focuses on one of the most pressing socio-economic problems in Bangladesh—price hike**.**

The passage sheds light on the causes, effects and solutions of price hike in Bangladesh.

The passage presents an overview of the problem of price hike in Bangladesh.

Develop the body by presenting the key points in a logical order. If the passage discusses a problem, you may organize your ideas by explaining the causes, effects, and solutions. Include only the most important information.

Use your own words. Avoid copying sentences directly from the passage. Paraphrase, condense, and combine ideas while preserving the original meaning.

Maintain coherence by using linking words such as Moreover, Furthermore, As a result, Consequently, Therefore, and Finally where appropriate.

Conclude your summary with phrases such as:Overall,...In conclusion,...Thus,...Therefore,...Ultimately,...

Summary:

The passage deals with the issue of price hike in Bangladesh, which has become one of the country's major socio-economic problems. It explains that this problem is mainly caused by overpopulation, corruption, business syndicates, smuggling, and the artificial shortage of essential commodities. As a result, many people with limited incomes struggle to meet their basic needs, while some children are forced to leave school. To tackle this problem, the passage suggests increasing food production, ensuring political stability, punishing dishonest businessmen, and maintaining a stable supply of essential commodities. Overall, the passage presents the causes, effects and possible solutions to the problem of price hike.

Thank You
Any Questions?